

IST Website

Vision v1.0

A living document communicating the overall structure, messaging, visual style, and user experience we are aiming for. This is not a finalized specification — it is a starting point for a collaborative build.

Use this brief as strategic and copy direction. The freelancer brings design judgment, animation craft, and responsive expertise. Preserve IST's real logo, brand colors, factual claims, and actual product capabilities. Do not invent features, partnerships, metrics, or UI screenshots.

HERO HEADLINE — LOCKED

Every Device. Any Network.

This replaces all previous hero candidates. It is bolder, bigger, and works for the full long-term vision including hardware and interoperability — not just mesh distribution.

Notes for Designer

Thank you for taking a look at our vision for the IST website. This document communicates the overall structure, messaging, visual style, and user experience we are aiming for. It is not a finalized specification — details will evolve as we build together.

SOME CONTENT IS INTENTIONALLY PLACEHOLDER OR SUBJECT TO REVISION, INCLUDING:

- Statistics and metrics — do not treat any numbers in reference mockups as final or approved
- Imagery — all images are directional placeholders unless explicitly marked as approved
- Copy — all text is directional and will be refined during the build process
- Navigation details — final nav structure may shift
- Product screenshots — no fabricated UI should appear in the final site
- Icons — icon direction is approximate, not final
- Page layouts — structure is directional, not pixel-perfect
- Social media links — to be confirmed
- Contact information — no email address should appear publicly on the site

OUR PRIORITIES FOR THIS BUILD

Visual design	A distinctive, premium aesthetic that reads as serious deep tech — not a template
Layout	Clear information hierarchy that communicates IST's story without overwhelming
Usability	Intuitive navigation, clear CTAs, no dead ends
Branding	IST black and burnt orange identity applied consistently throughout
Responsiveness	Flawless on mobile — this is a non-negotiable requirement
Complexity	Technical ideas communicated clearly to a mixed technical and non-technical audience

We are looking for a collaborative partner, not a pixel-matching service. We welcome design suggestions that improve the final product. If you see a better way to communicate an idea, lay out a section, or structure a page — tell us. The mockups in this document give the designer permission to think creatively, not an obligation to recreate every detail exactly.

REFERENCE SITES FOR VISUAL DIRECTION

cesiumastro.com · spaceapp.org

Dark, animated, mission-critical aesthetic. Serious without being impenetrable. Technical without being academic. Do not copy their layouts or visual identity — use them as a quality bar and tone reference only.

1. What This Redesign Must Accomplish

The current site communicates that IST is a serious technology company. The redesign must go further — positioning IST as a platform company with a complete networking intelligence stack in development, not a two-product startup. Locus and Crucible are the first expressions of a larger vision. The website must signal that without naming products that are not yet public.

The 10-second test: Within 10 seconds, a visitor should understand what problem IST solves, who it serves, why it matters, and what action to take next.

HOMEPAGE FLOW

#1 Hero	"Every Device. Any Network." — what IST does and why it matters
#2 Support line	The world is becoming autonomous. Communication was not built for that future. IST was.
#3 The Problem	Real networks disconnect because the physical world changes
#4 The Solution	IST adapts, stores, routes, and completes delivery
#5 How It Works	Short visual sequence — not a wall of technical text
#6 Locus	Assured data distribution engine — current, shipping
#7 Crucible	Simulation, validation, mission visualization — current, shipping
#8 Applications	Space, defense, drones, robotics, maritime, emergency response
#9 The Stack	Signal the broader platform — unnamed future layers — no product names
#10 Vision + CTA	Where IST is going and what action to take

2. Homepage Story and Copy Direction

The freelancer may refine wording for rhythm and layout but must preserve this meaning and keep language concrete. Do not introduce jargon, clichés, or unverified claims.

THE PROBLEM

Today's networks assume perfect connectivity. Reality does not.

Satellites move. Drones fly behind mountains. Ships disappear beyond the horizon. Robots lose line of sight. Conventional systems treat these interruptions as failures. IST treats them as the environment the network must survive.

THE SOLUTION

Networks should adapt. Not break.

IST intelligently stores, routes, and delivers information through changing networks until every intended destination receives what it needs. Missions should not stop simply because connectivity changes.

HOW IT WORKS

Networks change → IST adapts → information keeps moving → mission continues.

Use a short visual sequence featuring satellites, drones, robots, and maritime assets. Do not claim capabilities not yet demonstrated.

THE STACK SIGNAL — Section 9 on homepage

This section signals platform ambition without naming unreleased products. Show the layers of the IST stack as a visual — software, simulation, hardware, interoperability, ecosystem — with Locus and Crucible clearly live and the remaining layers marked "In Development" or "Coming Soon." No product names for unreleased layers. No fabricated capability descriptions.

Distribution Software	Locus — CURRENT
Simulation & Validation	Crucible — CURRENT
Network Processing Hardware	In Development — no product name
Protocol Interoperability	In Development — no product name
Developer Ecosystem	Coming Soon — no product name

Why this matters: Investors and sophisticated partners reading this page will immediately understand IST is building a full stack — not just two products. The restraint of not naming unreleased products signals maturity, not limitation.

THE VISION

IST is building toward a world where every device, on any network, can communicate intelligently — regardless of topology, protocol, or environment. That future requires rethinking networking from the ground up. That is what we are doing.

Note: Do NOT use "the future will not be one giant network" — this contradicts IST's actual hardware and interoperability roadmap. The corrected vision above is approved.

CTA LANGUAGE

Primary	See How It Works
Locus	Explore Locus
Crucible	Explore Crucible
Business	Discuss a Mission
General	Contact IST

3. Solutions Page Direction

The Solutions page uses a three-column layout signaling the full product category — software, simulation, and hardware — without naming unreleased products. This is the right balance between IP protection and platform signaling.

PAGE HEADER

Solutions Built for Dynamic, Intermittent Networks

IST delivers the software, simulation, and hardware needed to operate with confidence in the most challenging environments.

THREE-COLUMN PRODUCT LAYOUT

SOFTWARE Locus: Assured Distribution Engine Ensures mission-critical information reaches every destination through dynamic, intermittently connected networks until delivery is complete.

SOFTWARE Crucible: Mission Simulation & Validation
Visualize, test, and refine your mission and network before deployment so you can move forward with confidence.

HARDWARE Programmable Hardware That Adapts to Any Environment IST hardware is designed for performance, flexibility, and integration across air, space, land, and sea. Details coming soon.

The hardware column intentionally has no product name. "Details coming soon" is the approved language. Do not add capability descriptions, specs, or names beyond what is shown.

4. Locus Product Page

HEADLINE AND DESCRIPTION

Locus: Assured Distribution for the Real World

Locus is IST's assured distribution engine. It ensures mission-critical information continues moving through dynamic, intermittently connected networks until delivery is complete.

THE FOUR-STEP FLOW — Show as visual icons with labels

STOR E	Intelligently Store	Critical data is stored across the network — never lost, always available for forward delivery.
ROUT E	Find the Best Path	Locus continuously evaluates available links and routes information along the optimal available path.
ADAP T	Dynamically Adjust	As conditions change, Locus adjusts in real time — rerouting, resequencing, and recovering without operator intervention.
DELI VER	Ensure Every Destination	Delivery is not complete until every intended recipient has the complete payload. Not most. All.

HOW LOCUS WORKS — Diagram direction

Show a network of diverse assets — satellites, drones, ground vehicles, ships. Some links solid (connected), some dashed (intermittent), some absent (no connection). Data packets shown in transit, stored at intermediate nodes, and completing delivery via alternate paths. Final state: every node has received the complete payload.

Do not use a fabricated UI screenshot. Use a clean illustrated diagram.

FEATURE TILES — Four columns

Works in disconnected and degraded networks	Built for the real world, not ideal conditions.
Efficient bandwidth utilization	Uses every opportunity to move data forward — no wasted capacity.
End-to-end data integrity	Protects information from source to delivery — no partial payloads.

**Built for
mission-critical
systems**

Designed for the highest standards of reliability.

"WHY CUSTOMERS CHOOSE IST" — Locus differentiators

Mission-first

Built for intermittent networks from the ground up — not adapted from enterprise software.

Platform-agnostic

Integrates with existing infrastructure. No ground-side changes required.

**Single-node
insertion**

Delivers immediate value from day one. Scales linearly as adoption grows.

**Simulation before
deployment**

Crucible validates Locus configurations before they go into the field.

5. Crucible Product Page

HEADLINE AND DESCRIPTION

Crucible: Simulate. Validate. Deploy with Confidence.

Before deployment, watch your mission come to life. Build your network. Move your assets. See how terrain, movement, and interference impact connectivity — and how IST keeps information flowing.

THE FOUR-STEP FLOW — Show as visual icons with labels

BUILD	Build Your Environment	Create realistic terrain, obstacles, and conditions. Import real-world geography or define custom mission environments.
MODEL	Model Your Assets	Add satellites, drones, ships, robots, ground stations — configure their movement profiles and link parameters.
SIMULATE	Simulate Real Conditions	Test movement, interference, terrain effects, and network dynamics across the full mission timeline.
VALIDATE	Validate Performance	Measure results, identify failure points, and optimize before you deploy. Know before you go.

CRUCIBLE ANSWERS CRITICAL QUESTIONS BEFORE YOU DEPLOY

- ✓ Will my network reach every asset?
- ✓ How does terrain affect connectivity?
- ✓ What happens if a node is lost?
- ✓ How do interference and jamming impact performance?
- ✓ How does movement affect link quality over time?
- ✓ How much bandwidth do I actually need?

■ Do NOT use a fabricated Crucible UI screenshot. The UI does not yet exist in a form approved for public display. Use a clean illustrated diagram of the simulation concept instead — terrain, assets, links, and data flow. No mock dashboards, no invented metrics.

FUTURE FRAMING — Third-party developer ecosystem

Crucible is designed as an extensible platform. The long-term vision includes a developer ecosystem where operators, researchers, and third-party developers can build custom plugins — mission profiles, terrain datasets, custom asset types, and distribution algorithms — on top of the Crucible simulation core.

This framing is approved for forward-looking copy but must be clearly positioned as a vision, not a current capability. Language like "designed for extensibility" and "built to support a future developer ecosystem" is appropriate. Do not imply a marketplace exists today.

6. Applications Section

SECTION HEADER

Built for the Missions That Matter Most.

IST solutions enable reliable communication across a wide range of industries and mission-critical applications.

SIX APPLICATION TILES — Use real operational photography, not AI abstract graphics

SPACE	Reliable data delivery for satellites, constellations, and space systems.
DEFENSE	Secure, resilient communications for military and multi-domain operations.
DRONES & UAS	Persistent connectivity for drone teams and autonomous systems.
MARITIME	Connectivity beyond the horizon for ships and maritime operations.
EMERGENCY RESPONSE	Dependable communication that reaches every responder, every time.
INDUSTRIAL IoT	Reliable connectivity for remote and distributed operations.

SECTION CLOSER — Below the tiles

One Platform. Countless Possibilities.

From space to sea, air to ground — IST keeps your critical information moving so your mission never stops.

CTA: "Explore All Solutions →" linking to the Solutions page.

7. Remaining Pages

ABOUT PAGE

The Engineers Behind IST

IST was founded by engineers with experience building the systems that power defense, space, and critical infrastructure.

■ No founder biography, name, or employer history on this version of the site — future phase. No fabricated metrics (years of experience totals, programs supported, business value, jurisdictions). Use only verifiable, approved claims.

APPROVED ABOUT COPY

Connected systems are reshaping every critical domain — defense, space, logistics, infrastructure. That transformation demands more performance from the underlying technology than it was ever designed to deliver. IST was founded to change that. We are an advanced technology company focused on the intersection of intelligent systems, distributed computing, and next-generation hardware. Our work is grounded in deep engineering discipline and driven by a belief that the most critical infrastructure in the world deserves better than the solutions it currently has. We build for the long term — starting with today's hardest problems and engineering toward a future where connected systems are smarter, more resilient, and more capable than anyone thought possible.

VISION CARDS — Two tiles side by side

Our Mission	To make resilient communication possible anywhere, for any mission, at any time.
Our Vision	A world where every device, on any network, communicates intelligently — regardless of topology, protocol, or environment.

NEWS PAGE

Latest News & Updates

Stay informed on partnerships, milestones, product updates, and company news.

CATEGORY FILTERS — All · Company · Partnerships · Product · Media

■ All news content must be real and approved by Jordon before publication. Do not use the fabricated headlines shown in the reference mockups. The page design and filter system are approved — the content placeholders are not.

CONTACT PAGE

Let's Build the Future of Resilient Communication Together.

Whether you have a mission challenge, partnership opportunity, or just want to learn more — we'd love to hear from you.

FORM FIELDS: Full Name · Work Email · Company/Organization · I'm interested in (dropdown) · Message

■ Do NOT display any email address publicly on the contact page or anywhere on the site. All contact must route through the form to a backend email address. Office location "Denver, Colorado, USA" is approved. Social links: LinkedIn and X only.

INSIGHTS PAGE

IST is committed to advancing the state of the art in networked systems. This page serves as our hub for technical white papers, research publications, and industry perspectives.

First paper: "Distribution Completeness in Dynamic Mesh Networks: The Missing Layer" — IST Technical Research Series · July 2026 · Gated download (name + email required).

CAREERS PAGE

Build Something That Matters.

IST is building technology that does not exist yet — and we are looking for the engineers who want to build it with us. We are a small, focused team operating at the frontier of networked systems, and every person we hire has an outsized impact on what we build and how we build it.

Hiring line: "The technology of tomorrow needs the brightest minds of today. If you thrive on hard challenges, love the pace of real innovation, and want high autonomy with the responsibility to match — come help build something that matters. Get in on the ground floor."

8. Visual and Mobile Direction

BRAND PALETTE

Background	Black to dark charcoal (#0D0D0D → #1A1A1A) — avoid flat medium gray
Primary text	Warm white (#F0EDE8) — not stark blue-white
Accent	Burnt orange / copper (#C45200) — restrained and consistent
Supporting	Subtle charcoal, muted gray, or low-opacity orange for dividers

ANIMATIONS AND MOTION

Scroll animations	Elements fade or slide in on scroll — subtle, not distracting
Parallax	Background images move slower than foreground — effective on hero and vision sections
Network visualization	Animated node/link diagram for How It Works — nodes connecting, data flowing
Hover effects	Subtle zoom or color shift on buttons and product tiles
Stack reveal	Platform stack layers animate in sequentially on the homepage stack section

MOBILE REQUIREMENTS

- Hero headline fits naturally — no awkward single-word line breaks
- Navigation overlay has adequate contrast — black text on dark gray is not acceptable
- Buttons are comfortably tappable — do not dominate the full screen width on mobile
- Body text minimum ~16 CSS pixels with comfortable line spacing
- No horizontal scrolling on tables, diagrams, or cards
- Product diagrams simplify responsively — do not merely shrink
- Logo remains crisp and readable at phone size
- Stack section reflows cleanly on narrow screens

IMAGERY GUIDANCE

Prioritize real operational photography — satellites, ships, drones, command centers, field environments. The overuse of "glowing nodes on dark background" AI-generated graphics is ubiquitous in this category and undermines differentiation. Where product screenshots or simulation captures exist, use them. Where they do not, use high-quality photorealistic imagery of real operational environments.

9. Scope and Acceptance Checklist

DELIVERABLES

- Homepage — full flow as specified, desktop and mobile
- Solutions page — three-column layout with hardware column
- Locus product page — four-step flow, diagram, feature tiles
- Crucible product page — four-step flow, question checklist, no fabricated UI
- Applications section — six tiles with real photography
- About page — approved copy only, no bio, no fabricated metrics
- News page — design and filter system only, no fabricated content
- Insights page — paper tile design and gated download flow
- Careers page — approved copy and job posting tile template
- Contact page — form only, no email displayed publicly
- Reusable design system: typography, colors, buttons, cards, spacing
- Stack signal section — unnamed future-layer tiles with approved language
- Editable source files in Figma plus production-ready assets
- Implementation or complete developer handoff per contract scope

APPROVAL RULES

Technical claims	Jordon approves every technical claim before publication
Founder bio	No biography, name, employer history, or headshot on this version — future phase
Logos	No customer, investor, advisor, partner, or government logo without written permission
Metrics	No fabricated metrics, testimonials, valuations, or invented statistics of any kind
Unreleased products	No names, specs, or screenshots for hardware, interoperability, or ecosystem layers
UI screenshots	No fabricated Crucible or Locus UI screenshots — use illustrated diagrams only

Email	No email address displayed anywhere on the public-facing site
Ecommerce	Remove all cart, shop, or ecommerce UI artifacts
News content	All news posts must be real and Jordon-approved before appearing on site

A note on scope: IST is a platform company in early stage. The website should look and feel like the company it is becoming — not just the two products it is shipping today. Every design decision should be made with that ambition in mind. Signal boldly. Claim only what is true.